

Vox Populi on CachyOS

Civilization V + Vox Populi via Steam and Proton

Revision 10.7.1 · 2026-10-02 · Vox Populi 5.4.6 (stable) · Protontricks 1.14.1-1 · Proton 11.0 · CachyOS with native Steam; other distributions in §3.

No terminal is needed: the work happens in Steam, your package manager (Shelly on CachyOS; Octopi on systems installed before CachyOS 26.04), the Protontricks and Winetricks windows, the installer's wizard and your file manager.

Work through §4–§6 in order: Steps 1–3 prepare the game, Steps 4–8 install Vox Populi and §6 is the first launch. Every step that writes to disk ends in a **Check**; Step 8 checks the two wizard steps, 6 and 7.

WARNING marks a common failure, **CRITICAL** a step that decides whether this works at all.

Maintained at github.com/ryanmusante/vox-populi-cachyos; this README and vox-populi-cachyos.pdf (print-ready, US Letter) carry the same text.

Contents

BEFORE YOU START

1. How it works	1
2. Requirements	3
3. Other distributions	3

INSTALL

4. Preparing the game.	4
5. Installing Vox Populi.	5
6. First launch	7

CONFIGURE AND PLAY

7. Settings and stability.	7
8. Community Patch options	9
9. Adding other mods	10
10. Multiplayer	12

MAINTAIN

11. Updating	13
12. Uninstalling	13

WHEN SOMETHING FAILS

13. Troubleshooting.	14
14. Alternative installer.	15
15. Bug reporting	16

REFERENCE

16. Path reference.	16
17. Sources	17
18. Limits	19

1. How it works

Proton is mandatory. Vox Populi ships a Windows game-core DLL that the native Aspyr Linux build cannot load.

The installer is Inno Setup 6 (Installer Version 1.2), a plain Win32 wizard that needs no .NET and renders correctly under Proton.

It asks for two different paths.

Wizard page	Resolves to	Receives
Select Destination Location – the Documents path LEAVE AS IS	{userdocs}\My Games\ Sid Meier's Civilization 5 Under Proton: C:\users\steamuser\ Documents\... in the prefix	MODS\ (1) Community Patch MODS\ (2) Vox Populi MODS\ (3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files MODS\ (3b) 43 Civs Community Patch MODS\ (4a) Squads for VP MODS\ (5) Modpack Maker for VP Text\VPUI_tips_en_us.xml
Select the Civilization V folder – custom page, after Setup Type SET THIS ONE	Whatever you browse to – the REAL game install, reached through S:\ or Z:\ (Wine maps Z: to /)	Assets\DLC\VPUI (VP setups) Assets\DLC\UI_bc1 (EUI setups) Assets\DLC\Expansion2\ Expansion2.Civ5Pkg (replaced) Assets\DLC\Expansion2\Sounds\ XML\ MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml

The Documents default is already correct: it resolves inside the prefix, where the Windows build reads mods. On a clean prefix the Civilization V folder page arrives blank; the wizard fills it in from the registry or C:\Program Files (x86)\Steam\... only when such a game tree exists inside the prefix.

CRITICAL — Aim that page at the real Linux install and nothing needs copying. The wizard refuses a folder without Assets\DLC and all ten DLC folders, so on a clean prefix a wrong path is blocked, not installed. A game tree already inside the prefix — a copied install, say — passes that test, and the UI assets then land where the game never reads them.

Every DLC must be installed, not merely owned. The wizard blocks unless DLC_01–DLC_07, DLC_Deluxe (Babylon), Expansion (Gods & Kings) and Expansion2 (Brave New World) all exist — in practice the Complete Edition on Civ V 1.0.3.279.

It cleans up after itself. Before writing, it deletes the Documents folder's cache and Text\VPUI_tips_en_us.xml, the game folder's VPUI, UI_bc1, Expansion2.Civ5Pkg and sound XML, and the current VP mod folders. It also removes every legacy folder name back to the CBP/CBO/CSD era, including (4) Civ IV Diplomatic Features, (5) More Luxuries, the (6x) compatibility files, (7a) Promotion Icons for VP and (7b) UI - Promotion Tree for VP. Clear nothing by hand, and expect any edit inside a VP mod folder to be lost at the next install or update.

There is no uninstaller entry (Uninstallable=no). Removal is the **Uninstall all** setup type in the same .exe.

Releases are stable or beta. Each links a release-notes thread titled *New STABLE Version* or *New BETA Version*; 5.4.6 (2026-08-31) is stable.

2. Requirements

Item	Requirement
Game Steam	Civilization V 1.0.3.279, all expansions and all DLC installed Native Steam (multilib steam); data dir ~/.local/share/Steam, also reachable through ~/.steam/root. Other distributions: §3
Compat tool	Proton Experimental or newest numbered Proton (11.0 at this revision); proton-cachyos-slr OK. NOT a "Steam Linux Runtime" entry (Step 1)
Language	Game language English (Steam → Properties → Language). VP ships its text in English only; other languages show missing or stale entries
Tooling	extra/protontricks 1.14.1-1 with yad (its game list) and zenity (a Winetricks dialog tool, already a steam dependency); it pulls winetricks, which pulls wine and cabextract
Disk Conflicts	Full re-download of the Windows depots, plus the 110 MB installer VP's modinfo files block More Luxuries, CSD for VP, Civ IV Diplomatic Features (both), Artificial Unintelligence, Bridges and Canals, and standalone Squads for VP; remove them, Workshop copies included. No other mod may ship its own DLL

Every path in this guide sits in one of three folders. Steam → right-click **Sid Meier's Civilization V** → **Properties** → **Installed Files** → **Browse** opens the game folder; the library is the folder above steamapps, and compatdata/8930 always sits in the same library as the game. Show hidden files in your file manager — .local and .steam are hidden.

Folder	Location and contents
Steam library	~/.local/share/Steam – native Steam's default on CachyOS; a game in a secondary library uses that library. Other packagings: §3
Game folder	<library>/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V
Documents folder	<library>/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/drive_c/users/steamuser/Documents/My Games/Sid Meier's Civilization 5 – mods, saves, logs, cache and config.ini of the Windows build

3. Other distributions

Other distributions differ from CachyOS in three things — how Steam is installed, where its default library sits and whether their own Protontricks is recent enough; from Step 1 on, the procedure is the same.

Protontricks 1.12.0 is the floor: older releases cannot read the current Steam client's appinfo.vdf and stop with "Invalid file magic number".

Distribution	Steam	Protontricks
CachyOS, Arch Ubuntu 26.04 LTS Ubuntu 24.04 LTS	steam (multilib) steam-installer (multiverse) steam-installer (multiverse)	extra, 1.14.1 – Step 4 multiverse, 1.13.1 – use it multiverse, 1.10.5 – too old; use the Flatpak
Debian 13 Fedora 44 Steam Deck	steam-installer (contrib) steam (RPM Fusion Nonfree) preinstalled	none in trixie; use the Flatpak fedora, 1.13.1 – use it Flatpak, from Discover

Where the default library sits — the §2 library unless Civ V lives in a secondary one:

Steam packaging	Default library
Native package, any distro Arch, CachyOS Debian, Ubuntu Flatpak Steam Snap Steam	what ~/.steam/root links to ~/.local/share/Steam ~/.steam/debian-installation for a new install; older installs may sit in ~/.local/share/Steam ~/.var/app/com.valvesoftware.Steam/.local/share/Steam ~/snap/steam/common/.local/share/Steam

Debian and Ubuntu need the i386 architecture enabled and the multiverse (Ubuntu) or contrib (Debian) component before steam-installer is offered; Debian also wants the 32-bit Mesa packages that the Debian wiki's Steam page lists, or NVIDIA's 32-bit driver libraries (nvidia-driver-libs:i386) with the proprietary driver. **Fedora** takes Steam from RPM Fusion Nonfree and Protontricks from Fedora itself.

Where the table says **Flatpak**, add Flathub, install com.github.Matoking.protontricks and restart; on the **Steam Deck**, use Desktop Mode's Discover — SteamOS's root is read-only. Flatpak Protontricks reaches Steam's own directories plus the standard Desktop, Documents, Downloads, Music, Pictures and Videos folders, and ships the same app shortcut and Launcher entries; a library or installer elsewhere makes it report the folders it cannot reach and how to grant them.

Then, on any of them: start Steam once and sign in so it creates its directories, confirm in your package manager that Protontricks is 1.12.0 or newer, and continue with Step 1.

4. Preparing the game

Steps 1–3 switch Civ V to its Windows build under Proton, make sure every DLC is installed and create the Wine prefix.

Step 1 · Force Proton

Steam → right-click **Sid Meier's Civilization V** → **Properties** → **Compatibility** → tick **Force the use of a specific Steam Play compatibility tool** → Proton Experimental or the newest numbered Proton. Steam swaps the native build for the Windows depots; let it finish. If the download stops with a disk write error, see §13.

WARNING — The same dropdown lists Steam Linux Runtime entries. They are not Proton: no Wine prefix is created, and Protontricks stops with "Proton installation could not be found!".

CachyOS alternatives (install the package, restart Steam): proton-cachyos-slr, proton-cachyos-native, or protonup-qt / protonplus for Proton-GE. Prefer -slr — a Proton build that runs inside the Steam Linux Runtime container, not one of the bare *Steam Linux Runtime* entries above.

Proton 11.0 and Experimental map an S: drive to the game's Steam library, which shortens the path typed in Step 7; on Proton 10.0 or older the launch option PROTON_SET_GAME_DRIVE=1 %command% (**Properties** → **General** → **Launch Options**) does the same. If the library root is not writable or is on another filesystem, S: points at steamapps itself and the wizard path becomes S:\common\...; the Z:\ path always works.

Check: the game folder holds CivilizationV_DX11.exe among other .exe files. No .exe at all, and a Civ5XP binary instead, means Steam is still serving the native build.

Step 2 · Confirm every DLC

Steam → right-click **Sid Meier's Civilization V** → **Properties** → **DLC** → tick every entry.

Check: Assets/DLC in the game folder holds all ten — DLC_01-DLC_07, DLC_DeLuxe, Expansion and Expansion2. A missing one stops the installer at Step 7.

Step 3 · Launch once, then quit

Press **Play** in the Steam library window and pick **Play Sid Meier's Civilization V (DirectX 10/11)**, the DX11 build, from Steam's launch options; the game's own launcher was retired in November 2024. Wait for the main menu, then quit. This first launch creates the prefix, `compatdata/8930/pfx`, without which Protontricks cannot see the game, and builds Civ V's Documents tree inside it. A desktop shortcut or the tray icon starts the default DX9 build without asking, and the DX9 executable may start regardless (Proton #8327); neither affects Vox Populi.

Check: the Documents folder exists and holds Logs, Saves and `config.ini` among others.

5. Installing Vox Populi

Steps 4-8 add the runtime libraries, verify the installer, run it inside the prefix and check where it put the files.

Step 4 · Install Protontricks and the runtime libraries

Install protontricks and yad from the CachyOS repositories; zenity is already there as a Steam dependency (other distributions: §3). Then:

1. Open **Protontricks** from the application menu and pick **Sid Meier's Civilization V** — it is listed only after Step 3.
2. In the Winetricks window that opens, choose **Select the default wineprefix**.
3. **Install a Windows DLL or component** → tick `vcrun2008` → **OK**.
4. **Install a font** → tick `corefonts` → **OK**.

A warning that you are using a 64-bit WINEPREFIX is expected — Winetricks shows it for every 64-bit prefix, and every Proton prefix is one — so close it. Both installs download, so this needs network access; Winetricks skips what is already installed, so repeating the step is harmless.

`CvGameCore_Expansion2.dll` (both 5.4.6 variants) imports `MSVCR90.dll` and `MSVCP90.dll`, the Visual C++ 2008 runtime that `vcrun2008` installs; Wine's built-in copies usually suffice, but a report in [thread 702075](#) had VP working only after this step. `corefonts` adds the eleven Microsoft Core fonts for the Web and needs `cabextract`.

Check: opened again, those two lists show `vcrun2008` and `corefonts` already ticked.

Step 5 · Download and verify

Download `Vox.Populi.<version>.exe` from the release's assets at github.com/LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL/releases; the asset list shows each file's digest. `Release_Debug.zip` beside it is a debug DLL for crash reports, not needed for play. For 5.4.6:

`Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe` — 110,481,637 bytes
 sha256 31679423e55d7f64ba9693d8252d9e29f824fd9f8da043af547470068f98ba8a

Check: the digest your file manager computes matches (Dolphin: **Properties** → **Checksums**, paste the digest and it confirms the match). A mismatch means delete the file and download it again; do not run it.

Step 6 · Run the installer inside the prefix

Right-click `Vox.Populi.5.4.6.exe` → **Open With** → **Protontricks Launcher** → **Sid Meier's Civilization V**. The wizard can take a minute to appear and may open behind other windows under Wayland.

Step 7 · Complete the wizard

The actions in capitals decide the result:

Wizard page	Action
License · Information Select Destination Location Setup Type / Components Select the Civilization V folder Ready to Install Installing · Finished	Accept the agreement, then Next on both LEAVE UNCHANGED. It must read <code>C:\users\steamuser\Documents\My Games\Sid Meier's Civilization 5</code> CHOOSE one setup type – table below TYPE <code>S:\steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V</code> , or the <code>Z:\</code> form of the game folder given below CHECK that "Civilization V path" shows the <code>S:\</code> or <code>Z:\</code> path, not <code>C:\Program Files (x86)\...</code> Wait, then Finish

The setup types, in the installer's order:

Setup type	What it installs
Vox Populi (with EUI) Vox Populi (no EUI) Community Patch only 43 Civ Community Patch only, 43 Civ Vox Populi (no EUI), 43 Civ Vox Populi (with EUI) Uninstall all	Full VP + Enhanced User Interface – the usual choice Full VP, stock interface AI and bugfix base mod. NOT compatible with EUI The same three with a DLL supporting 43 major civs Removal – §12

The `Z:\` form is the game folder with `Z:` in front and backslashes instead of slashes; for the default library:

`Z:\home\<your user name>\.local\share\Steam\steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V`

If the Ready page shows a `C:\Program Files (x86)` path, go back and fix it rather than copy files afterwards. The information page warns that the installer fails if MODS has been moved out of the Documents tree; under Proton that only happens if you change the Documents page.

Step 8 · Verify placement

Check: Assets/DLC in the game folder now holds VPUI, plus `UI_bc1` with EUI — the pass/fail test for Step 7. Community Patch only installs neither, but adds `Expansion2/Sounds/XML/MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml` there. The Documents folder's MODS holds the numbered mod folders of your variant.

If `<library>/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx/drive_c/Program Files (x86)/Steam/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V` exists, a game tree inside the prefix took the files: re-run the installer with the correct path, or copy that tree's Assets folder over the real game folder's.

6. First launch

1. Launch Civ V from the Steam library window, as in Step 3.
2. Main menu → **MODS**; accept the prompt about DLC being disabled and the game restarting.
3. The first entry into the MODS menu runs a "configuring game data" pass of 5–15 minutes — not a hang. Thread 702075's opening post reports it may crash once and work after a relaunch.
4. Enable the VP mods the installer placed in MODS — the table below.
5. Press **NEXT**, never **Back**.
6. **Single Player** → **Set Up Game**.

Mod	When to enable it
(1) Community Patch	Always – every other VP mod requires it
(2) Vox Populi	Requires (1) Community Patch
(3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files	MUST be enabled on any EUI install, or VP will not function
(3b) 43 Civs Community Patch	Only for 43-civ variants
(4a) Squads for VP	Optional QoL – RTS-style control groups and group movement
(5) Modpack Maker for VP	Leave off for normal play; builds modpacks (\$10)

CRITICAL — Back returns to the main menu and silently deactivates the mod set — the most common "I installed VP and nothing changed" report.

Check: the main menu lists active mods in the lower right. EUI working but no new units, luxuries or advanced-setup options means the base game with EUI only — redo from the MODS menu without pressing Back. Trees that look unchanged, or entries with wrong text, mean the game language is not English (\$2).

7. Settings and stability

Recommended settings

Setting	Single player	Multiplayer
Autosave frequency	1 turn	1 turn
Max autosaves	0 (unlimited)	500
Leader Scene Quality	Minimum	Minimum
Yield icons	Off from the Industrial era	Off from the Industrial era – every player must do it

Single-player values follow the install thread and the bug-report form; the modpack thread asks for 500 autosaves in multiplayer. The aim is a save from the turn *before* a problem, which needs frequent autosaves that are never rotated away.

Crashes

Late-game crashes are a memory problem, not a Vox Populi bug. Civ V is 32-bit, and the project attributes most late-game CTDs (crashes to desktop) to address-space exhaustion. Mitigations, most important first:

1. Leader Scene Quality on Minimum.
2. Yield icons off from the Industrial era, or avoid zooming far out.
3. Standard or small maps.
4. A lower in-game resolution — ultrawide and 4K panels are the demanding case.

Proton already helps: `PROTON_FORCE_LARGE_ADDRESS_AWARE` is **on by default**, giving the 32-bit executable a 4 GB address space instead of 2 GB; leave it alone. Upstream tracks the same picture in #13344 (crash, likely out of memory) and the draft fix #13372 (intermittent crashes loading huge maps).

Early, random crashes are a different problem. ProtonDB reports tie them to thread count. Under Proton the reported fix is the launch option taskset `-c 0-7 %command%` (**Properties → General → Launch Options**), which pins the game to eight threads. One reporter instead raised `MaxSimultaneousThreads` in the Documents folder's `config.ini` (default 8) to the machine's thread count; another found that 24 stopped the game starting. Reports that edit that key under `~/.local/share/Aspyr` concern the native build; Proton never reads that file.

Performance and configuration files

Late-game turn times are AI-bound, not GPU-bound. Treat graphics settings as a memory lever rather than a frame-rate one, and cap the frame rate at the panel's refresh rate with VSync.

The game keeps its settings as plain-text `.ini` files in the Documents folder (§2) — under Proton, inside the prefix. Edit them with the game closed; the in-game menus write to the same files, and deleting them resets every setting to default at the next start.

File	What it holds
<code>config.ini</code>	Debugging, logging (§15), audio switches and startup parameters — <code>MaxSimultaneousThreads</code> (above) lives here
<code>UserSettings.ini</code>	User options — <code>SkipIntroVideo</code> , <code>NoBasicHelp</code> , <code>DisableAdvisorSpeech</code> and <code>AutoWorkersDontReplace</code> among them
<code>GraphicsSettingsDX11.ini</code>	Everything from Options → Video for the DX11 build: resolution, fullscreen, VSync, MSAA, the detail levels
<code>GraphicsSettingsDX9.ini</code>	The same for the DX9 build — each build keeps its own

Performance-first values for Options → Video, with the key behind each option in GraphicsSettingsDX11.ini. Forum benchmarks single out anti-aliasing and terrain tessellation; the rest are ordinary detail levels.

Options → Video	Key	Performance-first
Anti-Aliasing	MSAASamples	Off (1). Costliest item; DX11 AA can also black out the screen
VSync	WaitForVSync	On (1). Caps at the refresh rate, steadies frame times
Leader Scene Quality	–	Minimum – memory, above Low. On a weak GPU also set BicubicTerrainTessSubdiv 0
Terrain Tessellation Level	TerrainTessLevel, BicubicTerrainTessSubdiv	Low
Shadow Detail · Terrain Shadow Quality	ShadowLevel, TerrainShadowQuality	Low · off
Water Quality · reflections	TerrainWaterQuality, ReflectionLevel	
High Detail Strategic View	HDStrategicView	Off (0)
Overlay Detail · Fog of War · Terrain Detail Level	OverlayLevel, FOWLevel, TerrainDetailLevel	Low
Texture Quality	TextureQuality	High, unless late-game crashes point at memory

Two things only the files can do. `MinimizeGrayTiles = 1` in the graphics file stops the gray tiles that appear while scrolling on weaker GPUs (the official Steam FAQ's fix). `FullScreen`, `WindowResX` and `WindowResY` under `[UserSettings]` in the graphics file recover a game that opens at a size the screen cannot show; the DX11 build needs at least 768 pixels of height. `SkipIntroVideo = 1` in `UserSettings.ini` is the file form of the in-game *Skip Intro* option; the movie plays while the game loads, so skipping it leaves a black screen rather than saving time. For wall-clock time rather than frame rate, turn on **Quick Combat** and **Quick Movement** under Options → Game.

8. Community Patch options

The options file is `MODS/(1) Community Patch/Database Changes/NewCustomModOptions.xml` in the Documents folder. Its header sets three rules:

- An option with a **"See also:"** comment is enabled through its mod, not here.
- One listing **"Defines:"** or **"PostDefines:"** needs those defines verified first.
- Anything else is enabled by changing `Value` from 0 to 1.

A row's `Class` (0 Data ... 6 Major) describes what kind of option it is, not how safe it is. Leave `Class 3`, `Events`, alone unless you need it: those options run game-core triggers whether or not anything consumes them. The four options most people want:

Option	Effect
ENABLE_ACHIEVEMENTS	Steam achievements in modded single-player. Marked "FUNCTIONALITY NOT GUARANTEED" and it changes the savegame format – set it before a campaign, not during
DIPLO_DEBUG_MODE (+ ..._SETTING)	Reveals the AI's true opinion, approach and Congress voting; at setting 2 the AI accepts every Discuss request
SQLITE_LOGGING	Writes gameplay statistics to a queryable stats.db
CORE_DEBUGGING	Extra game-core debugging; slows the game, leave off

Delete cache after editing, and keep a copy of the file — the installer rewrites these folders on every update. Use `ENABLE_ACHIEVEMENTS` rather than the executable-patching method used for other modded Civ V setups; map-type achievements are broken on the native Linux build regardless of mods, but work under Proton.

9. Adding other mods

Rules for every added mod

Any mod that ships its own DLL is incompatible. VP replaces the Civ V DLL entirely, and the Community Patch cannot coexist with another DLL mod.
VP reworks most systems: anything beyond maps, civilizations, art or interface needs a version made for VP.
Steam Workshop subscriptions do not reliably land in the right place under Proton. Download from CivFanatics or GitHub and extract manually.
Mods go in the Documents folder's MODS — inside the prefix, beside the VP folders.
After ANY mod change, delete cache and ModUserData there before launching. Stale cache is the most common reason mods look broken.
Filenames do not need lowercasing under Proton; that applies to the native build.

Where compatible mods live

Mods for VP are posted in the Community Patch Project's [Mods Repository](#) subforum (Civ5 → Creation & Customization → Project & Mod Development → Community Patch Project). Its sticky [Mod Compatibility with Latest Version](#) (January 2026) says every mod there is meant to work with the current VP and asks for problem reports, with logs, in each mod's thread; mods that stop working move to the **Mods Archive**. A thread's opening post holds the download — an attachment, a file-host link or a GitHub repository — and its last pages hold the reports for 5.4.6. Copies in the site's **Downloads** section and on the Steam Workshop can lag by years: Even More Resources' Workshop page carries reports that it fails on VP 3.1.1.

The older list [MODS compatible with Vox Populi \(VP\)](#) was last edited in March 2022, before VP 5, and now sits in the forum's archive. Thread 702075 reports Community Events, Improved City View, most of WHoward's Pick'N'Mix and Info Addict (an extra patch with EUI) working under Proton, though the modpack maintainer warns that Info Addict is known to crash from memory overflow (§7).

Most popular compatible mods

The tables list the most viewed mod threads across all six pages of the Mods Repository that show 2026 activity and no reported breakage, most viewed first. Versions are as the authors state them; "thread active 2026" means 2026 posts but no stated VP version. Players' shared mod lists on the forum and on Reddit name the same core: More Wonders, Even More Resources and Unique City-States.

Gameplay and content:

Mod and author	What it adds	Version, needs, status
More Wonders for VP by adan_eslavo	New world and natural wonders	v24.11, VP 5.3.3+; an effects folder goes in the game folder (below) see also msw1's (7a)
Community Events by Enginseer	More random events	VP Events Overhaul, titled for 5.4.6 also on GitHub; skip the Workshop copy thread active 2026
Even More Resources for VP by HungryForFood	New bonus, luxury and city-state resources	
New Beliefs by pineappleadan, HungryForFood, Recursive	New religious beliefs	
Hokath's Proposals by hokath	Bundle of balance proposals	thread active 2026
Unique City-States by adan_eslavo	Unique traits for city-states	v19.3, VP 5.4.x
Cultural Components (5/6 UC) by hokath, gwennog, jarcast2	5th and 6th unique components per cultural group	v9, VP 5.4; needs JFD's Cultural Diversity (1) (Core) Utilities thread titled 5.3; active 2026
Enlightenment Era for VP by hokath	An era between Renaissance and Industrial	
Various Gameplay Tweaks by balparmak	Separate naval supply, veterancy, less micro	thread active 2026
JFD's Sovereignty for VP by Troll Warlord	Governments and reforms	v15 (2024): fixes only; thread active 2026
Better Lakes for VP by InkAxis	Lake rework	thread active 2026
Semper Fidelis by hokath	Ideologies expansion pack	thread active 2026

Interface, art and tools:

Mod and author	What it changes	Version, needs, status
Improved City View by Infixo	City screen rework	EUI installs only; needs (3a) thread active 2026
Dolen2's Ethnic Diversity by Dolen2	Culture-specific unit art	
City-States Leaders for VP by adan_eslavo	Leaders for city-states	v26, VP 5.3.x; made for Unique City-States
Trade Opportunities for VP by adan_eslavo	Trade screen rework	v26, VP 5.3.x
InGame Editor+ for VP by N.Core	In-game editor for map, cities and units	thread active 2026
Wonder Planner for VP by adan_eslavo	Planning screen for wonders	v20; More Wonders' opening post recommends it
Unit Scaling and Formation for VP, by N.Core	Unit model size and formations	thread active 2026

Custom civilizations are the repository's largest group. The most viewed are Colonialist Legacies' Inuit, Cambodia, The Goths, G&H's Kingdom of Scotland and MC and LITE's Nubia; the sticky *Map of Compatible Civilizations for VP* charts the rest. Most support JFD's Cultural Diversity, which is how Cultural Components reaches them.

Map scripts are the safest additions by the rules above; the most viewed active ones are jarcast2's Bigger Huge Maps (for Communitu_79a and Continental Drift) and axatin's Continental Drift Map Script.

Left out despite their popularity:

Mod	Why it is left out
More Unique Components (3/4 UC) Civics and Reforms Pineappledan Tweaks for VP Promotion Overhaul for VP Alternative Component Names Historical Religions Complete (Steam Workshop) Maritime Weather+, Maritime Battles+	Integrated into VP 5; do not install it Reported not working in a shared VP mod list (August 2025); no thread post since October 2024 No thread post since April 2024 Current version built for VP 5.2.x, per its author Marked outdated by its author Reported in December 2025 to no longer work with VP Crash reports in August 2025; a Maritime Battles rebuild was pending

Installing a mod

1. Download from the opening post, not the Steam Workshop (see the rules above).
2. Extract the archive with your archiver. A .civ5mod is a 7-Zip archive under another name; rename it to .7z if the archiver refuses it. The game can unpack a .civ5mod left in MODS when the MODS menu opens, but the forum reports that as hit-or-miss, so extract it yourself.
3. Move the folder that contains the .modinfo file straight into the Documents folder's MODS, beside the numbered VP folders — not the archive, not a folder inside a folder. Many mods carry a prefix such as (7a) so they sort after VP's own entries.
4. Opening posts give Windows paths. One under steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V means the real game folder (§2), never a C:\Program Files (x86) tree inside the prefix (Step 8); More Wonders' effects folder, for one, goes into the game folder's Assets/DLC/Expansion2/DLC.
5. Delete cache and ModUserData.
6. In the MODS menu, enable the VP set first, then the new mod; it lists what it requires — nearly all need (1) and (2), Improved City View needs (3a), Cultural Components needs JFD's Cultural Diversity (1) (Core) Utilities — then **NEXT**.

Add one mod at a time and play a few turns before the next, so a crash points at the last one added (§13). For multiplayer the mod must be part of the modpack (§10); a mod enabled through the menu cannot join a modpack game.

10. Multiplayer

VP cannot be played in multiplayer through the MODS menu; it must be packaged as a modpack that loads automatically as a DLC.

Preferred — a prebuilt modpack. The CivFanatics [modpack thread 685164](#) tracks current releases (5.4.6), including one generated on Linux under Proton. Extract so its folders — ZMP_MODPACK and any VPUI or UI_bc1 it carries — sit directly under the game folder's Assets/DLC, then delete the Documents folder's cache. Modpacks also work in single player and are easier to update than a MODS-menu install.

Alternative — build your own.

1. Enable (5) Modpack Maker for VP plus every mod to include.

2. Start or load a game and press **Ctrl+Shift+M**.
3. Check Logs/Lua.log in the Documents folder for errors (logging on, §15).
4. Exit and delete cache.
5. Relaunch and start from Single Player or Multiplayer, never the MODS menu.

Alternative — civ5vp-installer. It builds modpacks too (§14).

Modpack rules
Modpacks cannot be combined with mods activated through the MODS menu Every player must use byte-identical modpacks Every player must delete cache BEFORE EVERY LAUNCH, or the game will most likely crash after the first turn Do not hand-edit a modpack folder – rebuild or re-download it instead Saves do not record which modpack was used; a mismatch crashes Multiplayer autosaves live in Saves/multi/auto – collect them for desync reports

Remove a modpack by deleting its folders under Assets/DLC and the Documents folder's cache: VP_MODPACK for one you built; ZMP_MODPACK, VPUI and UI_bc1 for the thread's packs, per its opening post.

Known issues. Community-Patch-DLL #13349, open since 2026-09-05, reports a 5.4.x multiplayer desync that its reporter suspects lies in pathfinding; check its state before a long game. MPPatch, which would allow modded multiplayer without modpacks, has had no release since December 2023, and a forum report describes crashes with VP plus EUI.

11. Updating

Back up first: copy Saves and MODS from the Documents folder to somewhere outside the prefix. A prefix reset destroys the saves, and the installer rewrites the mod folders, losing any edit under MODS.

Then download the newer Vox.Populi.<version>.exe, check it against its own digest on the release page (Step 5) and run it exactly as in Steps 6–7. It deletes the old mod folders and cache before writing; no manual cleanup.

By the project's versioning rule, saves are compatible when only the third version component changes: 5.4.4 → 5.4.6 keeps them, 5.4.x → 5.5.0 does not.

WARNING — Steam's *Verify integrity of game files* restores the stock Expansion2.Civ5Pkg, which VP replaces to fix city-state audio. Re-run the VP installer after any verify.

12. Uninstalling

Preferred — Uninstall all. Re-run the installer, choose **Uninstall all** and point the Civilization V folder page at the same real install; this also restores the stock Expansion2.Civ5Pkg.

Fallback — manual removal. Delete these, then verify game files in Steam to restore the stock Expansion2.Civ5Pkg — verification leaves added files alone, hence the sound XML in the list:

Folder	Delete
Documents folder	MODS/(1) Community Patch · MODS/(2) Vox Populi MODS/(3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files MODS/(3b) 43 Civs Community Patch · MODS/(4a) Squads for VP MODS/(5) Modpack Maker for VP
Game folder	cache · ModUserData · Text/VPUI_tips_en_us.xml Assets/DLC/VPUI · Assets/DLC/UI_bcl Assets/DLC/VP_MODPACK or Assets/DLC/ZMP_MODPACK (modpacks, §10) Assets/DLC/Expansion2/Sounds/XML/MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml

Last resort — prefix reset. Delete <library>/steamapps/compatdata/8930; this also destroys the saves inside the prefix, so back them up first (§11).

13. Troubleshooting

Ordered by when the failure appears.

Setup and install

Symptom	Cause and fix
Steam: "disk write error" while it downloads the Windows depots (Step 1)	Steam client bug with case-mismatched depot folders (steam-for-linux #13406, closed as completed 2026-07-27). Update Steam and retry; reporters created the folder the error names, in that exact case, under steamapps/downloading/8930.
"Invalid file magic number"	Protontricks older than 1.12.0 cannot read the current appinfo.vdf. Upgrade, or use the Flatpak (§3).
Flatpak: "does not appear to have access to the following directories"	The installer or a library sits outside the folders the Flatpak can reach (§3). Move it, or grant the folder as the message says, then restart Protontricks.
Protontricks does not list Civ V	Prefix absent. Launch once via Proton (Step 3).
"Proton installation could not be found!"	Compat tool is a Steam Linux Runtime entry, not Proton. Re-select a real Proton build (Step 1).
"You are using a 64-bit WINEPREFIX"	Expected (Winetricks, Step 4): every Proton prefix is 64-bit. Close it.
"Cannot find cabextract"	Install the cabextract package.
"command cabextract ... returned status 1"	cabextract trips over a symlink Proton created. Delete the symlink the error names, then re-run.
Wizard never appears	Wayland focus or a broken Proton build. Check other windows, then try Proton Experimental or proton-cachyos-slr.
"did not provide the correct path"	Chosen folder has no Assets\DLC child. Point at the game root, not Assets or DLC.
"You don't have all required DLCs"	The message names the missing packs. Enable every DLC in Steam and repeat the Step 2 check.

In the game

Symptom	Cause and fix
DX9 starts despite choosing DX11	Proton report #8327, closed as not planned. Launch from the library window, not a shortcut or the tray icon (Step 3).
Crash during the first configuring game data pass	The thread-702075 opening post saw this once; relaunch and enter MODS again (§6); if it keeps crashing, delete cache.
VP absent from the in-game mod list	Documents page was changed; mods are outside the prefix. Re-run with the default Documents path.
Missing textures, broken UI	Civ V folder page pointed at a game tree inside the prefix. Re-run, or copy across per Step 8.
EUI works, no other VP features	Back was pressed in MODS, or (3a) is not enabled on an EUI install. Re-enable all mods, press NEXT.
Tech or policy tree unchanged, or entries show wrong text	Game language is not English. Steam → Properties → Language → English, then delete cache (§2).
Mods stale, duplicated or missing	Delete cache and ModUserData (§9). Then look for Workshop subscriptions sharing mod IDs, or a mod with its own DLL.
CustomModOption change has no effect	Cache not cleared, or the option needed its defines (§8).
Crackling audio	One ProtonDB report: launch option PULSE_LATENCY MSEC=60 %command%.
DX11 hangs after a few minutes	A January 2026 ProtonDB report ran stable with the launch option -dx9; another saw gray screen areas under DX9.
Random crashes early in a session	Thread count (ProtonDB reports). Pin to eight threads with taskset, or align MaxSimultaneousThreads (§7).
Crashes on NVIDIA	Two May 2026 ProtonDB reports crash on drivers 580.142 and 595.71.05; one reverted the driver. A July report on 580.105.08 runs. Not a VP fault.
Multiplayer crashes after turn 1	Cache not cleared before launch by every player (§10).
Crash to desktop in the late game	32-bit address-space exhaustion. Apply §7 in order, and keep the game folder's crashlogs for a report (§15).
Still broken after all of the above	Minimal install – VP without EUI, no other mods – then add EUI, then other mods, one layer at a time.

14. Alternative installer

github.com/Alpakinator/civ5vp-installer is a single-file native Linux binary (Apache-2.0) that installs VP without Protontricks — a fallback if the Inno wizard misbehaves, newer and less tested than the Protontricks route. It finds the Civ V folders itself (you can correct them), writes only to the game's MODS, DLC and Text folders and its cache, has a modpack mode, and its Uninstall button restores an unmodded game. The game itself still runs under Proton (§1).

civ5vp-installer-linux-x86_64 (v0.1.6, 2026-09-15) – 44,735,720 bytes
sha256 a0b59eb445d23bc9a5206ec0f592a7f81c4cfd40a5f2e0d823737bacbd271baa

Verify the digest as in Step 5, mark the file executable (Dolphin: **Properties → Permissions → Is executable**) and open it. Unofficial or in-development versions are compiled locally — about 1.1 GB of build tools once, roughly 5 GB in ~/.local/share/civ5vp-installer.

WARNING — Install release versions only. On 2026-08-26 the author advised against its "Compile the DLL myself" option, single player included: the compiler it currently uses probably drops loop checks from the C++ code, which can freeze the game.

Packs built by versions before 0.1.6 can show raw text keys for loading tips and EUI options (upstream issue #13364); rebuild and redistribute them with 0.1.6.

15. Bug reporting

Vox Populi bugs go to the project's tracker, github.com/LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL/issues, not the forum; errors in this guide go to github.com/ryanmusante/vox-populi-cachyos/issues. Upstream's bug form is the only route (blank issues are disabled). It requires the mod version, the installed components — the setup type from Step 7 — and a description, and asks for three attachments:

Attachment	Where it is
Save from one turn before the problem	Saves in the Documents folder — the reason for the autosave settings in §7
Logs	Logs in the Documents folder, zipped — useless unless logging was already on
Crash artifacts, when reporting a crash	crashlogs in the game folder, for crashes.log and the .dmp, per the issue form. The minidump guide instead says dumps land beside the game executable as CvMiniDump_*.dmp — check both places.

Logging is off by default and must be on *before* the problem occurs. Enable it in the Documents folder's config.ini: set ValidateGameDatabase, LoggingEnabled, MessageLog, AILog, AIPerfLog, BuilderAILog and PlayerAndCityAILogSplit to 1. (Upstream's docs name the folder "Civilization V"; it is "Civilization 5".) Collect logs *before* loading a game — most are erased on load. Turn logging back off when you are not chasing a bug; it rewrites a large directory continuously.

Dumps are not guaranteed under Proton: the DLL loads dbghelp.dll from the prefix's System32, so it depends on Wine's implementation. If none appears after a crash, say so in the report and attach the logs and save.

The project wiki, github.com/LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL/wiki, has guidance on writing a good report.

16. Path reference

Every location the guide uses, by folder. <library> is the §2 Steam library; indented rows sit inside the row above.

Location	Path
Steam library	~/.local/share/Steam by default, also ~/.steam/root;
Depot downloads	other packagings in §3 steamapps/downloading/8930 — disk write error (§13)

Game folder	<library>/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V
As the wizard sees it	S:\steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V, or its Z:\ form (Step 7)
DLC folders	Assets/DLC/DLC_01–DLC_07, DLC_Deluxe, Expansion, Expansion2 – all ten required (Step 2)
VP assets	Assets/DLC/VPUI · Assets/DLC/UI_bcl (EUI setups) Assets/DLC/Expansion2/Expansion2.Civ5Pkg Assets/DLC/Expansion2/Sounds/XML/ MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml
Mod extras	Assets/DLC/Expansion2/DLC – More Wonders' effects (§9)
Modpack	Assets/DLC/VP_MODPACK if built; Assets/DLC/ZMP_MODPACK if prebuilt (§10)
Crash artifacts	crashlogs, and CvMiniDump_*.dmp beside the game executable (§15)
Prefix	<library>/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx
C: drive	pfx/drive_c
Drive mappings (S:, Z:)	pfx/dosdevices
Phantom tree (Step 8)	drive_c/Program Files (x86)/Steam/steamapps/common/ Sid Meier's Civilization V – must not exist
Documents folder	drive_c/users/steamuser/Documents/My Games/ Sid Meier's Civilization 5
Mods	MODS – the numbered VP folders and any added mod (§6, §9)
Options file	MODS/(1) Community Patch/Database Changes/ NewCustomModOptions.xml (§8)
Caches	cache · ModUserData – delete after any mod change (§9)
Saves	Saves · Saves/multi/auto for multiplayer autosaves (§10)
Logs	Logs – most files only with logging on (§15)
Settings	config.ini · UserSettings.ini · GraphicsSettingsDX11.ini · GraphicsSettingsDX9.ini (§7)
Loading tips	Text/VPUI_tips_en_us.xml
civ5vp-installer data	~/.local/share/civ5vp-installer (§14)
Native build settings	~/.local/share/Aspyr – unused under Proton (§7)

17. Sources

Every row was verified on 2026-09-24; versions, releases, issue states and sources were re-checked on 2026-09-27 and 2026-10-02. Rows follow the guide's section order.

§	Fact	Source
§1	Installer behavior: two-path wizard, page order, setup types, DLC gate, cleanup, Uninstallable=no, Expansion2.Civ5Pkg swap, savegame rule	LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL – VPSetupData.iss, scripts/release.py, Opener.rtf; Inno Setup 6.1.0 source
§1	1.0.3.279 + all DLC; logging keys; minidump location and dbghelp.dll dependency	VP README.md, DEVELOPMENT.md, docs/minidumps.md
§2	Mod dependencies and blocked mods, EUI rules, VPUI/UI_bcl; Squads is QoL; modpack rules and removal; cleanup list	the six modinfo files; (1)/(2)/(3a) INSTRUCTIONS.txt and MANUAL INSTALL.txt; ModpackMaker.lua; VPSetupData.iss
§2	Game language must be English	CivFanatics thread 528034 FAQ; modpack thread 685164 OP; (1a) Community Patch – German Workshop page
§2	Package versions, dependencies and repositories; Shelly replacing Octopi	archlinux.org package DB; mirror.cachyos.org; CachyOS wiki: GUI
§2	Steam default dir and ~/.steam/root	Installer changelog, 26.04 Arch Wiki: Steam

§3	Protontricks app shortcut and Launcher, Flatpak access message, 1.12.0 appinfo.vdf floor, not-Proton message; Flatpak folders and desktop entries	Matoking/protontricks README, setup.cfg, TROUBLESHOOTING.md, 1.14.1 CHANGELOG.md and source; yad/zenity roles from the Arch optdepends; Flathub manifest (finish-args)
§3	Ubuntu, Debian and Fedora packages, Steam setup and default directory; NVIDIA 32-bit libraries on Debian	packages.ubuntu.com, Launchpad; packages.debian.org, sources.debian.org; Bodhi (protontricks-1.13.1-3.fc44); Debian wiki: Steam; RPM Fusion; Flathub; steam-installer 1.0.0.85 source
§4	Steam Linux Runtime breaks Protontricks; original copy-the-Assets workaround	TeaDrinkingProgrammer guide and its issue #3
§4	LARGE_ADDRESS_AWARE default; GAME_DRIVE and its 11.0 default; DX9/DX11 launch report	ValveSoftware/Proton README and proton script, 9.0 to 11.0; Proton issue #8327
§4	DX11 from Steam's launch options; shortcuts start DX9	2K Support, "Civilization V: Launcher Removal" (2024-11-18)
§5	Winetricks menus, vcrun2008 and corefonts contents, installed items pre-ticked, the 64-bit prefix warning	Winetricks/winetricks src/winetricks (20260125)
§5	Game-core DLL imports MSVCR90 and MSVCP90	CvGameCore_Expansion2.dll, both 5.4.6 variants, PE import table
§5	5.4.6 stable, asset name, size, sha256; still the newest release	GitHub releases + release feed (released 2026-08-31)
§5	Checksums and Is-executable in Dolphin	KDE Dolphin file properties dialog
§6	Linux mod handling, cache + ModUserData, known-good mods, first pass may crash once; runtime-library report; Debian Steam path	CivFanatics thread 702075 (schubman), now stickied; page 2 posts #21–#23 for the last two
§7	Autosaves; Workshop and DLL conflicts; minimal-install triage; compatibility list and its 2022 last edit	CivFanatics threads 528034 ("How To Install") and 542679 ("MODS compatible", in the archive)
§7	Late-game CTD from 32-bit memory; the mitigation order; beta vs stable naming	CivFanatics "Start Here" thread 701813
§7	Early-crash thread fix; NVIDIA, DX9/DX11 and audio reports	ProtonDB public data export, 2026-09-01: 196 reports for app 8930
§7	INI files, sections and keys; gray-tile fix; resolution recovery; tessellation cost; Skip Intro option and the loading behind the movie; INI reset	PCGamingWiki "Sid Meier's Civilization V"; Steam FAQ thread for app 8930; CivFanatics 384886, 382624, 381059, 386447, 644343, 505112, 472949, 400990 and 405977; Steam discussion threads
§8	CustomModOptions rules, Class legend, Events overhead, the four toggles	(1) Community Patch/Database Changes/NewCustomModOptions.xml
§8	Achievements via VP's own option; native Linux map-achievement breakage	bmaupin/civ5-cheevos-with-mods README, citing Community-Patch-DLL #12965
§9	Popular mods: ranking, authors, stated versions and requirements; prefixes; compatibility sticky, archive rule, Downloads and Workshop lag; 3/4 UC built in; left-out mods	CivFanatics Mods Repository (549), all six pages; stickies 701787 and 689101; opening posts of 653498 (More Wonders), 686269 (Unique City-States) and 701034 (Cultural Components); threads 699519 and 685164; Even More Resources page 28019 and its Workshop comments
§9	Community advice on what VP tolerates; recurring mod sets	Reddit r/civ5 and r/civvoxpopuli threads
§9	Community Events lineage and VP fork	TechpriestEnginseer/Community-Patch-Events-Development; n-core/VP-Community-Events

\$9	.civ5mod is 7-Zip; the .modinfo folder goes into MODS; in-game unpacking unreliable	CivFanatics threads 451941, 549219 and 477763; the (7a) Events Overhaul title
\$10	Prebuilt modpacks incl. Linux/Proton build, their folder names; MP autosaves; library-window launch tip; open 5.4.x desync; Info Addict; 2026 crash reports	CivFanatics modpack thread 685164 (OP, posts #721 and #732); Community-Patch-DLL #13349, open; #13344 open; draft PR #13372
\$10	MPPatch last release Dec 2023	Lymia/MPPatch release feed
\$13	Steam disk write error on case-mismatched depot folders	ValveSoftware/steam-for-linux #13406, #13433, #13436
\$14	Alternative installer: 0.1.6, asset, sha256, data dir, local-build warning, text-key bug	Alpakinator/civ5vp-installer README, CHANGELOG, v0.1.6 assets; CivFanatics thread 704249; Community-Patch-DLL #13364
\$15	Bug form: required fields, three attachments, crashlogs path, autosave rationale; wiki	.github/ISSUE_TEMPLATE/bug_report_v5.yml and config.yml; Community-Patch-DLL wiki

18. Limits

- **Written against 5.4.6.** Wizard page order and setup-type names have been stable but are not guaranteed; the sha256 is for 5.4.6 only.
- **Thread 702075 page 1 cannot be fetched verbatim** (metadata only), so its opening post is known from indexed excerpts; page 2 was read in full on 2026-09-19. Structural facts come from the Vox Populi source tree.
- **The modpack thread's opening post is also known only from indexed excerpts**, including the prebuilt packs' folder names.
- **The English-language requirement is a community FAQ item** (thread 528034, the modpack thread, the German language pack), not an upstream statement. The DX11 choice follows 2K's launcher-removal notice; that the tray icon also starts DX9 is a 2023 modpack-thread report.
- **\$3 was checked against package indexes and upstream documentation, not run** on those systems. Fedora's figure is the newest Bodhi update found for Fedora 44 (January 2026); a later one may exist.
- **The S: default was read from Proton's source, not observed**; the wizard refuses a wrong path, and Z: always works.
- **The runtime-library step rests on one forum report and the DLL's import table**; it was not reproduced on a clean prefix, and applying it is harmless.
- **The window routes were read from Protontricks' and Winetricks' sources**, and the file-manager steps describe KDE's Dolphin; other file managers put checksums and the executable bit elsewhere.
- **The performance-first values order options by the cost forum benchmarks reported** (2010–2013 threads, Windows); none were measured under Proton, and the numeric levels behind most detail keys are not documented beyond the samples those threads posted.
- **ProtonDB's page needs JavaScript**, so its public data export (2026-09-01) was read instead; the \$7 and \$13 items from it are community reports, not tested fixes.
- **\$8 toggles were read from the source file, not exercised.** ENABLE_ACHIEVEMENTS is marked "FUNCTIONALITY NOT GUARANTEED" upstream and changes the savegame format.
- **The popular-mod roster ranks thread views across all six pages of the Mods Repository** on 2026-10-02, keeping mods with 2026 activity and no reported breakage; versions are the authors'

statements, descriptions come from titles and opening posts. None was tested under Proton; a mod's last page is the authority for 5.4.6.

- **Upstream disagrees with itself on where crash dumps land** — the issue form says crashlogs, the minidump guide says beside the game executable. Both are covered.
- **Untested paths:** Flatpak and Snap Steam (procedure holds, paths move), the 43-civ variants, MPPatch and civ5vp-installer's local DLL build.